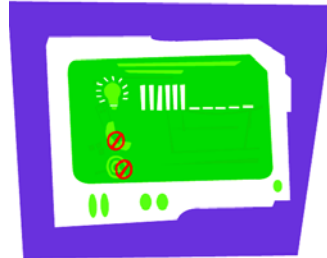




Smart Homes

While your family is enjoying the movie, your house automatically switches into your predefined 'Movie Mode'. It automatically lowers the ambient lighting by 70 per cent, rejects all phone calls from numbers of less than 'Level Three' importance, and turns off all communication notifications to your family.

This level also has increased security, as all members of the family are engrossed. Doors and windows are locked automatically, and the security alarm is activated to prevent unauthorised entry to the house or garage.



Data Syncing

As you head off to sleep, you place your watch in its cradle, where it is charged and transfers all newly recorded data, such as contact information and updated schedules, to the house computer. This will help the house decide what time to wake you tomorrow and also what you might need for work.

The kids, meanwhile, have carried the wireless LCD into their room, and are continuing their game from where they left off. You tell the house to cut off power supply and connectivity to the LCD in half an hour and go off to sleep; your kids mutter their disapproval, but value their allowances too much to actually complain.



Security

While the neighbourhood sleeps, your house is on full alert. A passing police car broadcasts its encrypted ID, which your house recognises as the trusted neighbourhood watch, and sends the patrol car the all-clear signal. The neighbouring houses do the same. Life is just too hard for burglars, especially after physical money was stopped—everything's electronic now.

The Technologies

Wireless: Everything uses WiFi or WiMAX to communicate—with high security and encryption.

Tracking: Everything has an ID and can be tracked or traced easily.

Storage: No gadget needs a sizeable hard disk anymore. All devices can share each others' storage as well as centralised storage.

Bandwidth: With advancements in wireless technologies, there is no more bandwidth crunch and no more messy cable laying; bandwidth is cheap.

AI: Artificial Intelligence is limited, but capable of handling mundane tasks, and is self-learning.

Networks: Networks are global and ad hoc, but secured with high encryption. ☒



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